

108 Other prepositions

Prepositions can be used to express relationships other than place and time, such as origin, ownership, and absence.

See also:

The passive **24** Verb patterns with prepositions **54** Prepositions **105**

108.1 "BY"

"By" has several common uses in English.

When used to talk about an action, it refers to something that is done to achieve a certain result.

RESULT ACTION
I fixed my television **by** hitting it.



It is used to say who wrote or made something.

I'm reading *1984* **by** George Orwell.



It is used to talk about methods of travel.

I always go to work **by** train.



"On foot" is an exception to this rule.

It can be used to form the passive voice.

This was painted **by** a famous artist.



FURTHER EXAMPLES

I broke my phone **by** dropping it in a puddle.



It's too far to walk into town.
It's much easier to go **by** bus.



This show is based on a short story **by** Jane Austen.



That new building was designed **by** a famous architect.

